Mason **Zarns**

I ship in the systems nobody else will touch, and I make the engineers around me faster.

CONTACT

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EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF MINNESOTA
B.S. Computer Science
Minor in Chemistry
Dec 2022 | Minneapolis, MN

STRENGTHS

LANGUAGES

Java	Python
SQL	TypeScript
Rust	Kotlin

TECHNOLOGY

Azure	Spring Boot
AWS	Angular
Splunk	Terraform
Docker	New Relic

CERTIFICATION

MICROSOFT CERTIFIED
Azure Developer Associate
AZ-204 Exam

KNOWN FOR

Shipping when requirements are fuzzy and deadlines are tight.

Setting the AI practices that tech leads and architects now follow.

Being the engineer other teams route to when they're blocked.

COMPETITION

CODE42 HACKATHON
Aug 2022 | Minneapolis, MN
First prize among 17 teams for a zipfile metadata tool that lifted exfiltration risk visibility 15%.

EXPERIENCE

PEARSON | Software Engineer III
Jan 2026 - Present | Minneapolis, MN

- Lead AI adoption across a 100-engineer organization: authored an 8-video internal series on real-world agentic workflows, driving adoption by 20+ engineers including four dev leads and two architects.
- Rebuilt the dependency-update workflow around AI tooling, cutting engineering spend from 43 to 5 hours per week and shipping security fixes twice as fast.
- Unblocked a month-long stall in an anti-tamper migration for exam-center software: isolated the root cause, decoupled a legacy runtime, and cut thousands of engineering hours from the migration's scope.

PEARSON | Software Engineer
Sep 2024 - Jan 2026 | Minneapolis, MN

- Delivered a zero-downtime modernization of a business-critical portal, splitting a monolithic Tomcat application into a CDN-delivered frontend and Kubernetes services: 40 integrated applications, a dozen teams, $96K/year in cloud savings.
- Redesigned defect triage, distributing ownership across the dev team: 25% faster resolution, 45% fewer customer escalations.
- Credited by multiple architects for an “eagle eye”: public kudos for defect catches, including fixes spotted in PRs that had already cleared architect review.
- Modernized observability with New Relic and Splunk dashboards and alerting (20+ manual hours/month), and cut developer ramp-up 40% with onboarding docs.

PEARSON | Associate Software Engineer
Apr 2023 - Sep 2024 | Minneapolis, MN

- Spearheaded Pearson's enterprise Azure migration from IaC design through production cutover, cutting infrastructure costs 20% while holding 99.7% availability across 10,000+ global test centers.
- Automated FedRAMP vulnerability scanning and remediation, reducing time-to-resolution 65% and unlocking $7M in federal contracts.

CODE42 | Cloud Software Engineering Intern
May - Dec 2022 | Minneapolis, MN

- Built customer-controlled file retention that dynamically manages AWS resource TTLs, cutting storage costs 45%, and introduced PR-triggered integration testing on ephemeral Terraform environments.

PROJECTS

SETTLERS OF CATAN | AI Agent
2024 - Present
Building toward a superhuman Catan bot. Rewrote the core engine in Rust for a 20x speedup, contributed 10 features to open-source Catanatron, and implemented AlphaZero and Masked PPO strategies.